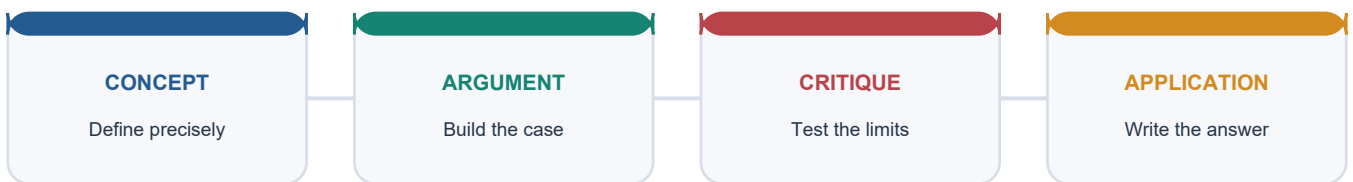


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 08 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Method**?

- A. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- B. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- C. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- D. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Method.
- **B:** B Attaches to Integration, not Method.
- **C:** C Attaches to Regularities, not Method.
- **D:** D Attaches to Verification, not Method.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Method by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Approach**?

- A. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- C. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- D. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Normative statement, not Approach.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Approach.
- **C:** C Attaches to Post-behaviouralism, not Approach.
- **D:** D Attaches to Post-behavioural, not Approach.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Approach by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Empirical statement**?

- A. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- B. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- C. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
- D. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Systematization, not Empirical statement.
- **B:** B Attaches to Quantification, not Empirical statement.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Empirical statement.
- **D:** D Attaches to Techniques, not Empirical statement.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Empirical statement by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Normative statement**?

- A. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- C. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- D. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Post-behaviouralism, not Normative statement.
- **B:** B Attaches to Approach, not Normative statement.
- **C:** C Attaches to Post-behavioural, not Normative statement.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Normative statement.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Normative statement by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Behaviouralism**?

- A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
- B. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- C. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
- D. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Behaviouralism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Values, not Behaviouralism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Leo Strauss, not Behaviouralism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Pure science, not Behaviouralism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Behaviouralism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Post-behaviouralism**?

- A. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- B. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- C. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- D. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Approach, not Post-behaviouralism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Post-behaviouralism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Normative statement, not Post-behaviouralism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Post-behavioural, not Post-behaviouralism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Post-behaviouralism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Traditional**?

- A. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
- B. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- C. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.
- D. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Verification, not Traditional.
- **B:** B Attaches to Regularities, not Traditional.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Traditional.
- **D:** D Attaches to Method, not Traditional.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Traditional by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Behavioural**?

- A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
- B. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.
- C. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- D. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Behaviouralism, not Behavioural.
- **B:** B Attaches to Pure science, not Behavioural.
- **C:** C Attaches to Values, not Behavioural.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Behavioural.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Behavioural by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Post-behavioural - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- B. Approach - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
- C. Normative statement - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- D. Post-behaviouralism - Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Records the association: Post-behavioural is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Approach is recorded with A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Normative statement is recorded with A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Post-behaviouralism is recorded with A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Post-behavioural; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Method - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- B. Regularities - political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- C. Verification - political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- D. Traditional - A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Method is recorded with The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- **B:** B Matches the record: Regularities is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Verification is recorded with those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Traditional is recorded with Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Regularities; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Method - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- B. Regularities - political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- C. Verification - those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
- D. Traditional - A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Method is recorded with The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Regularities is recorded with political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Verification is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Traditional is recorded with Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Verification; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Approach - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- B. Systematization - A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- C. David Easton - A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- D. Techniques - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Approach is recorded with A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Systematization is recorded with research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- **C:** C Mismatched: David Easton is recorded with Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.
- **D:** D Correct attachment: Techniques is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Techniques; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Quantification - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- B. Empirical statement - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
- C. Integration - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- D. Method - Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: Quantification is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Empirical statement is recorded with A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Integration is recorded with political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Method is recorded with The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Quantification; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Pure science - Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
- B. Values - an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- C. Behavioural - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- D. Behaviouralism - A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Pure science is recorded with understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.
- **B:** B Correct attachment: Values is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Behavioural is recorded with Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Behaviouralism is recorded with A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Values; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Approach - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- B. Techniques - A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- C. Systematization - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- D. David Easton - A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Approach is recorded with A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Techniques is recorded with rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Systematization is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: David Easton is recorded with Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Systematization; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Behavioural - Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
- B. Behaviouralism - A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data; the other dimensions would remain secondary under this reading.
- C. Values - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction; this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.
- D. Pure science - understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Behavioural is recorded with Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Behaviouralism is recorded with A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Values is recorded with an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- **D:** D Records the association: Pure science is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Pure science; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Integration** is associated with: political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
2. **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach** is associated with: Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Integration does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **David Easton - systems analysis** is associated with: political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.
2. **Decision-making approach** is associated with: political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with David Easton - systems analysis does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach** is associated with: every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).
2. **Marxian approach** is associated with: politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach** is associated with: Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
2. **Leo Strauss** is associated with: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Decision-making approach** is associated with: political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.
2. **David Easton** is associated with: A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Decision-making approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Marxian approach** is associated with: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
2. **Method** is associated with: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Marxian approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Leo Strauss** is associated with: Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
2. **Approach** is associated with: A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Leo Strauss does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **David Easton** is associated with: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
2. **Empirical statement** is associated with: Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with David Easton does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Method and approach are synonyms.**?

- A. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- B. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- C. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- D. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Method and approach are synonyms, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical.**?

- A. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- B. Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110)
- C. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- D. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Traditional always means normative, and contemporary, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Any sentence with "ought" is normative.**?

- A. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- B. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- C. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- D. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Any sentence with "ought" is normative, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Value-free means politically consequence-free.**?

- A. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122); the other dimensions would remain secondary under this reading.
- B. Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- C. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122); this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.
- D. Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Approach means Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Value-free means politically consequence-free, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.**?

- A. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)
- B. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- C. Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- D. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Approach means Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.?**

- A. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- B. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- C. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)
- D. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.?**

- A. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- B. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- C. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- D. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Method means A corrective within behavioural, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Approach means Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.**?

- A. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)
- B. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- C. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- D. Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Approach means Politics is illuminated through, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *distinguish* requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Method, Core and Conclusion, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation disciplined and publicly testable.

Model answer (138 words):

Introduction: Method and approach both organise inquiry, but they operate at different levels. Core analysis: A method is a procedure for obtaining, testing and interpreting knowledge, such as observation, comparison, historical reconstruction or statistical analysis. An approach is wider: it includes methods but also criteria for selecting the problem, relevant actors, admissible data and explanatory variables. A behavioural approach, for example, directs attention toward observable conduct and may then use surveys or quantification as methods. A philosophical approach selects conceptual coherence and normative justification as central problems and uses argument as a method. Yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation

disciplined and publicly testable. Conclusion: The distinction matters because method governs the reliability of inquiry, whereas approach also governs its intellectual agenda by deciding which problems, actors and evidence become visible.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Method, Core and Conclusion), converts that evidence into analysis of method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation disciplined and publicly testable. At 138 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Empirical, Core and Gauba's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively.

Model answer (134 words):

Introduction: Empirical and normative statements differ by the kind of claim they make, not simply by whether their wording contains 'is' or 'ought'. Core analysis: An empirical statement describes an observable relation that can be checked through evidence, repetition or consequences. A normative statement expresses a value, obligation or preferred order and requires moral justification. Gauba's examples expose the grammatical trap. 'Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work' can be empirical in content because the proposed condition may be tested against democratic functioning. Correct classification requires asking whether the claim is verifiable, evaluative or a combination requiring both forms of reasoning. Conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Empirical, Core and Gauba's), converts that evidence into analysis of must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively. At 134 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Examine behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive examine requires the answer to test the proposition rather than describe it, weighing what supports and what weakens it. Fix the boundary of behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Behaviouralism, Core and Eastonian, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them.

Model answer (141 words):

Introduction: Behaviouralism reoriented political science toward the systematic study of actual political behaviour rather than exclusive reliance on formal institutions or inherited texts. Core analysis: Its commonly taught Eastonian tenets are regularities, verification, techniques, quantification, value separation, systematization, pure science and integration. Regularities make generalisation possible; verification tests claims against observation; techniques and quantification improve precision; value separation distinguishes empirical explanation from ethical judgment; systematization connects theory and research; pure science gives explanation logical priority over application; and

integration opens political science to other social sciences. Wallas, Bentley, Merriam and Lasswell prepared this movement by studying psychology, groups, power and policy. Scientific rigour enlarged political knowledge, but could not decide which questions deserved priority. Conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them.

Why this earns marks: it obeys examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Behaviouralism, Core and Eastonian), converts that evidence into analysis of behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them. At 141 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Post-behaviouralism, Core and Easton's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that it does not replace verification with conviction.

Model answer (238 words):

Introduction: Post-behaviouralism arose from dissatisfaction with behavioural political science's retreat into tractable method while public crises demanded responsible knowledge. Core analysis: Easton's correction preserved behaviouralism's achievements-regularities, verification, rigorous technique and empirical explanation-but added relevance and action. Relevance requires research to address significant problems such as war, poverty, discrimination and injustice instead of selecting questions only because they are easily measured. Action requires scholars to accept responsibility for applying knowledge toward social betterment. The movement also made value choice explicit: deciding what to study and whom research serves cannot be treated as politically innocent. Further development: Its correction also changes the scholar's role. Behavioural detachment protects research from propaganda, but detachment cannot mean indifference to how knowledge is selected or used. Relevance identifies important public problems, action connects findings to possible remedies, and value-consciousness requires explicit justification of ends. The residual danger is that urgency may reward weak evidence or ideological certainty. Post-behaviouralism succeeds only when public responsibility is joined to reproducible inquiry and critical scrutiny. Critical evaluation: This is not permission for unsupported activism. Evidence standards remain necessary, and a fashionable cause does not validate weak analysis. Post-behaviouralism corrects the purpose and public orientation of science; it does not replace verification with conviction. Its durable position is therefore a synthesis of rigour, relevance and accountable action. Conclusion: Post-behaviouralism is best understood as value-conscious science: it retains verification and technique while restoring relevance, action and public responsibility.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Post-behaviouralism, Core and Easton's), converts that evidence into analysis of post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that it does not replace verification with conviction. At 238 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Compare the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Easton's and Almond's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously.

Model answer (248 words):

Introduction: The five models organise political explanation around different units and mechanisms, so comparison must ask what each reveals and conceals. Core analysis: Easton's systems analysis traces demands and supports through conversion into outputs and feedback, explaining persistence and adaptation. Almond's structural-functional model compares the universal functions performed by different formal or informal structures. Deutsch's communications model treats government as a steering process dependent on information flow, load, lag and corrective feedback. Decision-making analysis reconstructs who chose among which alternatives under particular informational, value and organisational constraints. Marxian analysis locates institutions and ideas within the economic base, class relations and dominant interests. Further development: Model choice should follow the explanatory problem. A demand moving through institutions is suited to Easton's input-output-feedback cycle; comparison across unlike formal structures is suited to Almond's functional grid; bureaucratic learning is illuminated by Deutsch's information flows; a discrete policy choice requires decision-process reconstruction; and concealed ownership power calls for Marxian analysis. Objections also differ: systems and functionalism are criticised for stability bias, communications for underplaying conflict, decision-making for ignoring pre-structured alternatives, and Marxism for economic reductionism. Triangulating models can test whether one model's omitted variable changes the conclusion, but models cannot simply be stacked without a clear causal sequence. Their strengths are therefore conditional, not cumulative proof of one master model. Conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Easton's and Almond's), converts that evidence into analysis of the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously. At 248 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Can political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive can requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Behaviouralism and Strauss, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Political science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends.

Model answer (241 words):

Introduction: The ideal of value-free political science seeks to protect factual explanation from the researcher's moral preferences, but it cannot remove values from every stage of inquiry. Core analysis: Behaviouralism usefully separates empirical propositions from ethical evaluation and demands verification, regularity and disciplined technique. This prevents desired conclusions from substituting for evidence. Strauss objects that political inquiry cannot understand tyranny, justice or the good regime while refusing to judge values; selection of politically important problems already presupposes standards of significance. Post-behaviouralism converts that criticism into methodological reform: research must retain scientific rigour while becoming relevant, action-oriented and conscious of its public consequences. Further development: The empirical-normative distinction should be preserved even when complete neutrality is rejected. Whether turnout changed, an institution complied with a rule or an attitude correlates with behaviour remains an evidential question. Whether participation is adequate, compliance legitimate or an attitude unjust requires evaluative reasons. Strauss protects the latter inquiry; behaviouralism disciplines the former; post-behaviouralism asks how the two can address public problems together. The remaining danger is ideological capture, where relevance becomes an excuse to predetermine findings. Transparent question selection, replicable evidence, explicit value premises and openness to criticism provide a stronger settlement than either scientific withdrawal or untested activism. Value control is possible; complete value absence is not. Conclusion: Political

science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends.

Why this earns marks: it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Behaviouralism and Strauss), converts that evidence into analysis of political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Political science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends. At 241 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
